

have predicted them during design if consulted. Platform design must be a collaborative practice, not a top-down architectural decree.

The enterprises that will extract durable competitive value from AI over the next decade are not necessarily those with the largest GPU clusters or the most sophisticated models. They are the ones that invest deliberately in the unglamorous, architectural foundations that make AI reliable, governable, cost-efficient, and continuously improvable at scale. Infrastructure is the multiplier on every model investment. A mediocre model on excellent infrastructure will outperform an excellent model on fragile infrastructure in every dimension that matters in production: reliability, latency, cost, and adaptability. The organisations best positioned to adapt are those that have invested not just in today's platform, but in the architectural principles, team capabilities, and governance frameworks that make continuous evolution possible.

For leaders, the strategic question is not: "Which AI infrastructure vendor should we choose?", but rather: "Are we investing in the foundational capabilities that will let us respond to the AI innovations of 2028 with the same agility we need in 2026?" Infrastructure debt in

AI compounds faster than in any other technology domain — because models, data, and workload patterns change on timescales of months, not years. The time to address that debt is now, while the field still rewards disciplined architectural thinking over reactive spending. **END!** 

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